

# ΣΩΝ

## Sigma Omega Nu

Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



## National Standing Rules

Approved 08/08/2026

# National Standing Rules

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# **Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. National Standing Rules**

## **Article I. Proposal Procedure**

### **Section A. Procedure**

Any Officer in Good Standing with National Board may submit a proposal at any time. Chapters may submit proposals only after approved by 3/4th majority vote by the Chapter's Active membership. Only the elected Chapter Representative may submit the proposal to the National Board Vice President. Proposals written by alumnae may be submitted, at the discretion of the Executive Cabinet.

Should any member of the National Board wish to propose a change to any of the governing documents of Sigma Omega Nu, the following procedure must be followed.

1. The proposal must be submitted on Official Sigma Omega Nu Letterhead. The proposal must include a narrative explaining the reasoning or justification for the proposed change.
2. The proposer must write the proposed changes in the same format as the document in which she wishes to see the changes. This includes the article, section and subsection (as appropriate). The proposal must clearly identify which portions of the document are being changed, either through tracked changes, a different font color, or highlighted text. The proposer must also include in the proposal a calendar date when the proposed changes would take effect.
3. The proposer must submit the proposal to the National Board Vice President and National Vice President of Communications no later than 21 days prior to the next National Council meeting. If the proposal is sent directly to any other(s), it will not be accepted or considered. If the proposal is being submitted by a Chapter, a copy of the Chapter meeting minutes documenting when the proposal was discussed and voted on must also be provided.
4. The National Board Vice President will distribute the proposal to the National Board members and Chapters who are required to attend the National Council meeting no later than 14 days prior to the next National Council meeting. Additionally, the proposal will be available on the Member Only section of the National Website no later than 14 days prior to the next National Council meeting. The National Vice President will notify the National Vice President of Communications to add the accepted proposals to the next National Council Agenda.
5. The proposal will be discussed and voted on at the National Council meeting by all eligible to discuss and vote. A  $\frac{3}{4}$  majority vote will be needed in order to pass the proposal.
6. The results of the proposal will be posted on the Member Only section of the National Website within seven (7) days after the National Council meeting. If passed, the National Vice President of Communications will incorporate the changes into the appropriate documents within 30 days, and notify the National Board and all Chapters when the updated documents are available.

## **Section B. Disqualification**

Proposals improperly submitted will not be considered. In addition to the requirements identified in Section A., this includes the following:

1. Proposals submitted to any Officer, Representative or Chapter, other than those officers specified above.
2. Proposals written as opinion statement without including proposed revisions in the format of the document under review.
3. Proposals submitted less than 21 days before the next National Council meeting.
4. Proposals submitted by Inactive Sisters, Little Sisters, or Advisors.

## **Article II. Meeting Procedure**

### **Section A. Meeting Order**

1. Call to Order – National President
2. Founders' Chant – All Members
3. Roll Call & Quorum – National Vice President or Parliament
4. Review and Approval of Last Meeting's Minutes
5. Review and Approval of Current Meeting's Agenda
6. Action Items
7. Officer Reports
8. New Business
9. Old Business
10. Announcements
11. Adjournment – National President

The National President shall oversee the general running of the meeting, and the National Vice President of Parliament shall keep order.

### **Section B. Robert's Rules of Order**

Meetings shall follow Robert's Rules of Order, as specified in Article XIII, Section H of the National Bylaws.

A basic outline of Robert's Rules of Order is below.

1. Agenda
  - a. All meetings shall follow a fixed agenda as listed in Section A above.
  - b. If anyone wants to discuss anything not already on the agenda, they must request it be added to the agenda before it is approved.
2. Motions
  - a. Obtain the Floor

Those permitted to participate in discussion must raise their hand in order to be recognized by the National Vice President of Parliament.

b. Make a Motion

With the expectation of proposals seeking to modify governing documents, a motion cannot contradict any existing governing document.

c. The motion must be clear and specific to the topic being discussed. It must be stated in the form of “I motion to...” or “I move to...” Second to the Motion

One other member permitted to participate in discussion must second the motion. There will be no further discussion on the motion until there is a second to the motion.

If there is no second to the motion, the motion dies and there is no further discussion. If the motion dies, a new motion can be made.

d. Discuss and Debate the Motion

The original motioner may explain the motion, show evidence to support, explain why this would work best, etc. Those permitted to participate in discussion are allowed to ask questions and voice their opinions.

Friendly amendments may be proposed by others, but need not be accepted by the original motioner.

e. The National Vice President of Parliament shall limit the amount of time spent on discussion and can end it when she sees fit. Re-state the Motion

Once discussion is concluded, the original motioner must restate the motion.

If the original motioner decides to include any proposed amendments suggested during discussion, the motion must be restated incorporating those amendments. Discussion on the amended motion may continue if necessary.

f. Vote on the Motion

If there is no further discussion, the vote is taken. Only those eligible to vote are permitted to do so.

A simple majority (51%) affirmative vote is needed to pass the motion.

For matters concerning finances or revisions to the governing documents, a three-fourths (75%) affirmative vote is needed for a motion to pass.

g. New Motions

A new motion cannot be presented unless the existing motion dies, is voted on, or is tabled

h. Tabling a Motion

A motion may be tabled for a set period of time or indefinitely, to be discussed at a later time.

All motions, including who motioned, who seconded, any amendments, and the final vote, shall be documented in the meeting minutes. Additionally, the National Vice President of Parliament shall keep a separate log of all motions passed and the date they take effect.

## **Article III. Letters of Excuse**

### **Section A. National Officers**

When an Officer of the National Board is unable to attend a meeting or activity where her attendance is required, she must submit a typed letter, no later than one (1) week prior to the meeting or activity, to the National Vice President of Parliament requesting her absence be excused.

In the event of an unforeseen circumstances or emergency situation that prevents a member from attending an event or activity, the member must immediately notify the National Vice President of Parliament via phone call, text message, or email notifying her of the absence. The member shall be given the opportunity to submit a Letter of Excuse as soon as possible after the unforeseen or emergency situation is resolved.

Any Letter of Excuse submitted will be read, discussed, and voted on at the next National meeting after when the letter is received. A simple majority vote is required to pass a Letter and excuse the absence. If the letter is not passed, the member will be fined the appropriate amount for the missed meeting, activity, and/or deadline.

### **Section B. Chapter Representatives**

If the elected Chapter Representative is unable to attend a National meeting or activity where her attendance is required, the Chapter must identify a replacement Representative and notify National Board Vice President of Parliament and the National Vice President of Communications a minimum of one (1) week prior to the National meeting or activity. The contact information of the replacement representative must also be submitted at this time. If the Chapter is unable to identify a replacement Representative due to a mandatory Chapter event, the elected Representative may submit a Letter of Excuse on behalf of the entire Chapter. If a Representative is not present, regardless of the reason, the Chapter will be fined by the National Board for the missed event or activity.

### **Section C. Format**

All Letters of Excuse must be submitted on Official Sigma Omega Nu Letterhead. The letter must be typed, not handwritten, and sent to the National Vice President of Parliament via email. Specific file format shall be at the discretion of the National Vice President of Parliament.

## **Article IV. Digital Records**

Every member of the National Board shall maintain and safeguard the digital records associated with their membership and office through the Sorority's official digital platforms. The official repositories for governing documents, officer records, and organizational files shall be the Sorority's designated Google Drive, official officer Gmail accounts, National Gmail account, or other approved digital systems.

### **Section A. Member Access**

Members of the National Board shall have access to the Sorority's governing documents, including but not limited to the Bylaws, Standing Rules, agendas, minutes, and other official records through the Sorority's designated digital repository (ex. Google Drive or Gmail). Members are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of these documents and shall not share or distribute access to unauthorized individuals. Members shall protect their login credentials and comply with all access and security procedures established by the National Board.

## **Section B. Officer Records**

Each Officer shall maintain the records, correspondence, reports, guides, forms, and other resources related to the duties of their position within the Sorority's official digital systems. Each Officer shall use their assigned officer Gmail account and designated Google Drive folders, or other approved digital platforms (ex. Canva, Wix), to organize and maintain all records pertaining to their position. Officers are responsible for ensuring that these records remain accurate, organized, and up to date throughout their term.

## **Section C. Officer Transition**

As part of the officer transition process, each outgoing Officer shall ensure that all electronic files, records, correspondence, and resources have been properly organized and maintained within the Sorority's official digital systems. The outgoing Officer shall transfer all applicable access, permissions, passwords, and organizational materials associated with the position to the incoming Officer in accordance with the Sorority's established transition procedures. No official records shall be maintained solely on personal accounts or personal storage devices.

# **Article V. National Active Alumnae**

National Active Alumnae status is available to members holding Alumnae status who wish to maintain an active relationship with the Sorority at the national level, independent of affiliation with a specific undergraduate chapter.

## **Section A. Dues**

National Active Alumnae dues shall be assessed annually in the amount of \$240. Payment of National Active Alumnae dues shall include the following:

1. Recognition as a National Active Alumna
2. Access to national alumnae communications, including newsletters and official updates issued by the National Board.
3. Inclusion in alumnae recognition or highlight features on the Sorority's official website or social media, in a manner and frequency determined by the National Board
4. Priority registration access for anniversary galas and alumni dinners hosted at the national level, subject to established registration deadlines, capacity limitations, and applicable registration fees
5. Includes registration at one national event per year (either National Conference or Battle of the Chapters). If the member elects to attend, they must email National Vice President of Alumnae Affairs in accordance with established deadlines.
6. Registration fees for other national events shall be assessed separately and shall apply uniformly to all eligible participants, regardless of membership classification.
7. A 10% discounted rate on event Vendor Fee; applicable on individual event vendor fee and annual vendor free.
8. Forty percent (40%) of all National Active Alumnae dues collected shall be allocated to the Sigma Omega Nu Member Scholarship Fund.

## **Section B. Status and Term**

1. National Active Alumnae status shall be obtained upon payment of the required dues and completion of any registration or verification procedures established by the National Vice President of Alumnae Affairs.



2. National Active Alumnae status will be due July 1st and valid for the designated fiscal year of July 1st through June 30th, regardless of the date of payment. Dues paid after July 1st will not extend status beyond the current fiscal year.

## **Section B. Rights and Responsibilities**

1. National Active Alumnae status does not also grant the member Chapter Active Alumnae status. If the member wishes to also hold Chapter Active Alumnae Status, she must request that through the individual Chapter, as outlined in the Chapter Bylaws.
2. National Active Alumnae shall comply with all national policies, codes of conduct, and standards of the Sorority.

## **Article VI. Fines**

Every National Board member of ΣΩΝ is responsible for meeting any deadlines once those deadlines have been agreed upon. In the span of our involvement with ΣΩΝ, there will inevitably be instances where time is important and being punctual or turning things in by deadlines is crucial. Tardiness and missed deadlines are often a burden for the person responsible. Fines are as follows:

### **National Meetings**

Late Letter: \$10

Failure to Submit a Letter: \$20

Unexcused Absence: \$25

Arriving Late or Leaving Early

One to five minutes - \$5

Six to ten minutes - \$10

Eleven or more minutes - \$15

### **National Activities or Events**

Late Letter: \$10

Failure to Submit a Letter: \$20

Unexcused Absence: \$50

Arriving Late or Leaving Early

One to five minutes - \$10

Six to ten minutes - \$15

Eleven or more minutes - \$20

### **Prospective Chapter Activities or Events**

Late Letter: \$10

Failure to Submit a Letter: \$20

Unexcused Absence: \$50

Arriving Late or Leaving Early

One to five minutes - \$10

Six to ten minutes - \$15

Eleven or more minutes - \$ 20

### **Missed Deadlines**

Any deadline - \$10

### **Incomplete Payments**

Bounced Check – \$25, or amount charged by the bank

Returned Payments – \$25, or amount charged by the bank

Incomplete Transfers – \$25, or amount charged by the bank

### **Late Fee**

See National Board Bylaws, Article XII. Finances, Section D. Fines & Late Fees.

## **Article VII. Alcohol & Drug Policy**

### **Section A. Definitions**

The following definitions are used within the following article.

1. Sorority funds: any money collected from dues, amounts collected as part of any official sorority event (e.g. Chapter formal, part of a ticket to a fundraiser party), and money collected via a fundraiser.
2. Official Names of Sigma Omega Nu: any of the three official names specified in the National Bylaws, Article V. Identification.

### **Section B. Use of Alcohol & Drugs**

1. No member in the Sorority is allowed to neither consume any alcoholic beverage nor use unprescribed drugs nor be under the influence in any manner while wearing or using any paraphernalia of ΣΩΝ. This includes, but not limited to, attire, jewelry, and drinking glasses that have any of the Official Names of Sigma Omega Nu, or that have the Sorority or Chapter Crest, in part or in whole.
2. Any photos of Sisters consuming alcohol or drugs shall not be used in any official publicity of ΣΩΝ. This includes photos of any Sister holding or using anything that may be assumed to be alcohol or drug paraphernalia.
3. Any photos or videos of Sisters wearing any paraphernalia of ΣΩΝ that have tags, captions, stickers, etc. that associate the picture with the use or consumption of alcohol or drugs are strictly prohibited. This includes posts made on official Chapter websites or social media, as well as on the personal websites or social media accounts of individual Sisters.

### **Section C. Sorority Events**

1. Alcohol shall not be present as part of any official Sigma Omega Nu event unless the Sorority enters into a valid contract with a third-party vendor who holds a valid liquor license for the sale of alcohol. Ceremonies and socials must be adjourned before any alcohol is consumed by any person present (not limited to sisters of ΣΩΝ).
2. Alcohol is permitted to be served at official Sorority events if and only the Sorority enters into a valid contract with a third-party vendor who holds a license for the sale of alcohol and has agreed to properly monitor its distribution for the entire length of the event. The contract must be submitted for review by the members of National Board at least 6 weeks prior to the event, and is subject to a majority vote.
  - a. In the event that a contract is unavailable a minimum of 6 weeks prior to the event for any reason, a letter shall be submitted to the National Vice President explaining why. The contract must be submitted immediately once signed.

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- b. In the event of a venue change at any time, a letter shall be submitted to the National Vice President explaining why. An updated contract shall also be submitted.

#### **Section D. Sorority Funds**

The following shall apply to the use of Sorority funds for the purchase of alcohol.

1. Sorority funds shall not be expended for the purchase of alcohol, mind altering substances, or any drugs (including prescription drugs).
2. Donations of alcohol shall not be accepted by any member, Chapter, or member of the National Board member for the purpose of resale.
3. No funds shall be accepted or derived from the direct sale of alcohol by the Sorority or in any form that can be viewed as the Sorority directly selling alcohol except as defined in Section C above.

#### **Section E. Consequences**

1. Failure to comply with any of the terms in Section B. Use of Alcohol & Drugs, above, shall result in the following consequences:
  - a. For National Board members, including Chapter Representatives, this shall result in the inability to wear ΣΩΝ attire for a period of six (6) months.
  - b. For any other member, this shall result in the inability to wear ΣΩΝ attire for a period of four (4) months.
2. For National Board members, failure to comply with any of the terms in Sections C. Sorority Events and/or Section D. Sorority Funds, above, shall result in immediate removal from office as well as 6 month suspension period.

#### **Section F. Alcohol Awareness**

All Undergraduate Chapters and Colonies are required to attend an alcohol awareness workshop each academic year. This workshop must be presented by an outside source such as the University's health center. Attendance at an alcoholic support group meeting is considered acceptable.

### **Article VIII. Hazing Policy**

#### **Section A. Standardized Pledgeship**

All potential new members and Pledges of Sigma Omega Nu shall be treated as respectfully as initiated members of this organization. At no time shall an initiated member of Sigma Omega Nu request or require Little Sisters to perform any act, task or assignment that she is not willing to do herself at the same time. The entirety of Pledgeship shall follow the rules and requirements of Standardized Pledgeship, as approved by the National Board, and no member or Chapter shall deviate from it. In addition, anything requested or required of a Little Sister or Pledge Class must also be completed by a minimum of one initiated member.

#### **Section B. Acts of Hazing**

1. No member of Sigma Omega Nu shall, at any time, request or require of Little Sisters (from any Chapter or Prospective Chapter) anything that shall be considered hazing under the law, nor shall any member of Sigma Omega Nu ever commit an act towards Little Sisters that may be considered hazing under the law.
2. Acts of hazing shall be considered to include, but not limited to, the following: any act that is in anyway degrading, humiliating, physically or mentally abusive, verbally abusive, physically harmful,

intentionally cruel, or illegal, for any reason. Acts such as the following are absolutely and strictly forbidden: paddling/spanking, kidnapping, carrying of large/heavy objects, forced feeding/drinking, forced masturbation, branding, nudity, hosing, servitude, or exposure to extreme elements/conditions. Tasks required of Little Sisters solely for the pleasure or benefit of Members are not acceptable.

3. No member who has consumed alcohol and/or mind-altering or illegal drugs, including those prescribed by a physical, is permitted to participate in any official Little Sister meetings, activities or events for a minimum of twelve hours following consumption of the last drink or drug. In addition, any member who has used or consumed alcohol and/or drugs cannot make requests of nor give new assignments to any Little Sister(s).

### **Section C. Pledge Mother Contract**

1. Prior to the pinning of a new Pledge Class, all Pledge Mother(s) shall be required to sign a contract stating that she shall abide by the hazing policy at all times. Failure to do so shall be grounds for removal from office. The Pledge Mother Contract must be emailed to the National Board President and National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs.
2. It is the responsibility of the Pledge Mother(s) to ensure that the Hazing Policy is followed and adhered to by all Chapter members.

### **Section D. Chapter Sister Contract**

1. Prior to Pinning, all Chapter Sisters who are permitted to be involved with the Little Sisters in accordance with their designated Member Status are required to sign a contract stating that she shall abide by the Hazing Policy of both Sigma Omega Nu and the University at all times. Failure to do so shall be grounds for Judicial Review. This includes any Alumnae who intend to participate in the Pledgeship process.
2. It is the responsibility of the Pledge Mother(s) to ensure that all Sisters involved with the Pledgeship Process, sign the Chapter Sister Contract. The Pledge Mother(s) is to keep them on file until the Pledgeship Process has ended.

### **Section E. Judicial Consequences**

1. Those members of Sigma Omega Nu who fail to abide by the Hazing Policy shall be subject to review by the Chapter Judicial Committee and/or the National Judicial Committee. Those found in violation of Section A. Standardized Pledgeship, above, shall be placed on Disciplinary Probation, and prohibited from contact with potential new members or Little Sisters for a sanctioned amount of time. Those found in violation of Section B. Acts of Hazing, above, shall be suspended from Active Membership and/or National office, and shall be prohibited from association with the organization, including its Little Sisters, for a minimum of one calendar year, starting at the conclusion of the Judicial Review.
2. Any member in violation of any of the above Sections at the Chapter level who is not placed under review at the Chapter level shall be placed under review at the National level immediately after the National Board is informed.
3. Any member in violation of the above Sections during a Prospective Chapter Pledgeship shall be placed under review at the National level.

## **Article IX. Honors & Recognition**

### **Section A. National Gold Member**

When a member of Sigma Omega Nu has been an Officer of the National Board, other than a Chapter Representative, for three consecutive years, she shall be considered a National Gold Member in recognition of her time and dedication to the organization. She shall receive the “Outstanding Contribution” plaque at the Annual Conference. The National Board shall provide for the plaque.

### **Section B. Gold Member**

When a member of Sigma Omega Nu has been an Active Member of an Undergraduate Chapter for eight (8) consecutive quarters or five (5) consecutive semesters after the term in which they crossed, she shall be considered a Gold Member of the Sorority. This recognition is given at the Undergraduate Chapter level. See Chapter Bylaws for more information.

### **Section C. Annual Awards**

The following awards must be presented annually at the National Conference.

#### **1. Outstanding Chapter Community Service**

Presented to the Chapter that has completed the most hours of community service, based on the annual Chapter Standards submittals.

#### **2. Outstanding Chapter Philanthropy**

Presented to the Chapter who has been the most involved with their chosen Philanthropy, based on the annual Chapter Standards submittals.

#### **3. Outstanding Community Service**

Presented to the Member who has completed the most individual hours of community service, based on the annual Chapter Standards submittals.

#### **4. Chapter of the Year**

Presented to the Chapter with the highest Chapter Standards score, based on the annual Chapter Standards submittals.

#### **5. Sister of the Year**

Presented to the Sister that has excelled at all aspects of academic, cultura, and sisterhood, based on a nomination submitted by one or more Sisters and reviewed by a committee of National Board Officers.

#### **6. Alumna of the Year**

Presented to the Alumna Sister that has provided exceptional support to one or more Undergraduate Chapters, based on a nomination submitted by one or more Chapters and reviewed by a committee of National Board Officers.

## **Article X. S.O.N. Member Scholarship Fund**

### **Section A. Fundraising**

The National Director of Fundraising shall be responsible for fundraising for the S.O.N. Member Scholarship Fund. The dollar amount of each award will depend on the amount of money raised.

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## **Section B. Applicants & Award**

The S.O.N. Member Scholarships shall be awarded annually to the undergraduate member(s) of this organization who have submitted an application and have met the sorority GPA requirement of 2.3 term and 2.5 cumulative. The Executive Cabinet will review applications and transcripts, and score each applicant on a standardized rubric. The applicant with the highest score for each scholarship category shall be the awarded recipient of each S.O.N. Member Scholarship. There shall be a minimum award of \$250.

The five scholarship categories are as follows:

1. La Mujer Scholarship

Awarded to a well-rounded Sister who exemplifies all three of the Sorority objectives, and who has proven what it means to be a sister of Sigma Omega Nu.

2. The Academics Scholarship

Awarded to a Sister who has demonstrated a commitment to academic excellence.

3. The Cultura Scholarship

Awarded to a Sister who promotes cultural awareness throughout the University campus and the local community.

4. The Sisterhood Scholarship

Awarded to the Sister who has demonstrated what it means to be a true Sister.

5. The Sunnie Money Scholarship

Awarded to the Sister who demonstrated the most financial need.

## **Section C. Presentation of Scholarships**

The S.O.N. Member Scholarships shall be awarded at the Annual Conference by the National President or National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs. Deposit to the recipient's accounts will be made within one month of the Annual Conference by National Vice President of Finance. Recipient need not be present to win.

## **Article XI. Pledgeship Privacy Policy**

### **Section A. Prohibition**

The following are prohibited from these social media sites:

1. Pictures before, during or after the Pinning Ceremony, regardless of content, including pictures with the Crest/Banner;
2. Pictures before or during the Big Sister Little Sister dinner, regardless of content;
3. Pictures before or during the Crossover Ceremony;
4. Pledgeship activities or assignments that are otherwise not seen by, open to or known by the general public;
5. Lists of the names of Little Sisters;
6. Captions, labels, "posts," "tags" or other similar identifying information referring to any of the above.

### **Section B. Permission**

1. Any assignment that is otherwise seen by, open to or known by the general public is permitted to be seen on social media sites. This includes community service, fundraisers, and the class gift.

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2. Pictures taken with Little Sisters following the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner must be taken away from the location of the actual ceremony or event such that a non-member cannot identify the context in which the picture was taken.
3. Pictures taken after the Crossover Ceremony may be shared so long as no candles, crowns, or boutonnieres are visible. Pictures must be taken away from the location of the actual ceremony or event such that a non-member cannot identify the context in which the picture was taken. The Crest/Banner cannot be visible in the picture.
4. Chapters and Sisters must wait a minimum of 24 hours after Crossover prior to posting pictures of newly initiated members.

### **Section C. Consequences**

Failure to abide by Section A Prohibition or Section B Permission, above, can result in judicial review of the Sister by the Chapter and/or the Chapter by National Board as stated in the Code of Ethics.